

Practice Quiz: Organizational Systems — Module 06: Learning

Name: ____ Date: ____

Part A: Multiple Choice

1. Organizational learning in Active Inference means: A) Sending employees to training courses B) Updating the generative model's parameters or structure based on accumulated prediction errors C) Reading industry publications D) Hiring experienced people
2. **Single-loop learning** differs from **double-loop learning** in that: A) Single-loop is faster B) Single-loop corrects actions within the existing model; double-loop questions and revises the model itself C) Double-loop requires twice as many meetings D) They are identical
3. IBM's shift from hardware to services exemplifies: A) Single-loop learning (better execution of the same strategy) B) Double-loop learning (fundamental revision of the generative model from "hardware company" to "services company") C) No learning at all D) Defensive routines
4. A **competency trap** occurs when: A) Employees have too many skills B) Deep expertise in current capabilities makes new, initially inferior approaches seem unworthy of investment C) Training programs are too expensive D) The organization has no competencies
5. **Superstitious learning** is: A) Learning from folklore B) Attributing success to the wrong cause, reinforcing an incorrect causal model C) Learning too quickly D) Not learning at all

6. Which learning loop has the longest cadence in most organizations? A) Operational (daily/weekly) B) Tactical (monthly/quarterly) C) Strategic (annual) D) Transformative (crisis-driven or proactive)
 7. **Defensive routines** prevent learning by: A) Increasing training budgets B) Creating organizational behaviors that suppress threatening truths before they reach decision-makers C) Hiring defensive consultants D) Building physical barriers
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Part B: Short Analysis

1. A retail chain has experienced declining same-store sales for three consecutive quarters. The executive team attributes this to "temporary macroeconomic conditions" and maintains the current strategy. Using the double-loop learning framework, argue that the team may be trapped in single-loop thinking. What questions should they ask to trigger double-loop learning? What organizational structures might be preventing deeper inquiry?
2. Your organization recently conducted a post-mortem on a failed product launch. The post-mortem concluded that "execution was poor." Using the Active Inference framework, redesign the post-mortem to dig deeper: What model predictions were wrong? What sensory data was missed or misinterpreted? What specific parameters or structures of the generative model should be updated?
3. Design a learning system for a hospital's surgical department. The system must capture lessons from both successful and unsuccessful surgeries, distinguish between systematic patterns and one-off events, and protect psychological safety. How does this system map onto the Active Inference concepts of prediction error, model updating, and precision?